Colossians 2:1–7 — Leader / Learner Guide

The Believer's Education · a one-page guide for leaders and learners

Christ Is All — A Study of Colossians · TheGospelVault.com · @iJohn.316 (Instagram)

① Big Idea and Context

Big idea: All the treasures of wisdom and knowledge are in Christ, so believers should not be deluded by persuasive arguments but keep walking in Him as they received Him.

Paul's "striving" (1:29) becomes a "struggle" (2:1) for the Lycus Valley churches he has never visited, now pressured by teachers who said Jesus was not enough.

- **The wish:** hearts encouraged, knit in love, knowing Christ, God's mystery.
- **The warning:** no one is to delude you with plausible arguments.
- **The admonition:** walk in Christ as you received Him.

② Christ Is Enough — Three Anchor Verses

Verse	What it says	Teaching point
2:2–3	*"God's mystery, that is, Christ Himself, in whom are hidden all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge"*	The real hidden treasures are in Christ, available to every believer.
2:6	*"as you have received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk in Him"*	Continue as you began: by grace through faith.
2:7	*"firmly rooted … built up … established … overflowing with gratitude"*	God roots, builds, and establishes; we overflow with thanks.

Military picture (v.5): "good discipline" and "stability" describe unbroken ranks and a firm line.

Laodicea: Paul wanted letters exchanged (4:16); the Laodicean letter may be Ephesians.

③ Teaching Flow

1. **Paul's struggle (2:1)** — For Colossae, Laodicea, and all who have not seen his face.
2. **The three steps (2:2)** — Knit in love; full assurance of understanding; knowledge of Christ, God's mystery.
3. **The treasury (2:3)** — All wisdom and knowledge hidden in Christ; God's wisdom reconciles the irreconcilable.
4. **Warning and assurance (2:4–5)** — Beware plausible arguments; Paul rejoices in their order and firm faith.
5. **Keep walking (2:6–7)** — As received, so walk: rooted, built up, established, overflowing.

④ Clarify While Teaching

- **Textual variant (v.2):** NASB95 "God's mystery, that is, Christ Himself"; NKJV "the mystery of God, both of the Father and of Christ." Either way the mystery is Christ.
- **"Laodicean letter" = Ephesians:** a reasonable suggestion, not a certainty.
- **Participle tenses (v.7):** "rooted" is perfect; "built up" and "established" are present; only "overflowing" is active.
- **"Judaizers":** the Colossian error mixed Jewish law with philosophy and angel worship; it was not identical to the Galatian problem.

⑤ Discussion and Close

1. Have you ever been tempted to think that Jesus plus something else would complete your Christian life?
2. What does it mean to walk in Christ "as you have received" Him?
3. Why does it matter that three of the four participles in verse 7 are passive?

Close: Next, Paul names the threat directly: "Beware of philosophy," and shows our completeness in Christ (2:8–15). "Therefore as you have received Christ Jesus the Lord, so walk in Him."

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